

Control Tower Incident Severity and Escalation Matrix

AfaqRoute Logistics Services Co. (ARLS) | Saudi Arabia Operations

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Purpose

To provide a common severity model so Control Tower staff escalate based on operational, customer, financial and cargo risk rather than exception label alone.

Scope

Applies to shipment incidents and systemic operational events monitored by ARLS.

1. Severity matrix

Severity	Typical triggers	Owner	Escalation target
S1 Critical	Theft/tampering, dangerous-goods safety event, critical cargo incident, regulatory exposure	Head of Ops	Head of Ops + Security/Compliance immediate
S2 High	High-value cargo stalled, >24h unexplained hold, major commercial failure, penalty >= \$50k	Ops Manager	Commercial / Account leadership
S3 Medium	Document issue, supplier delay, first failed delivery, carrier delay, shipment recovery path	Shipment Owner	Functional lead as thresholds require
S4 Low	Planned closure, minor ETA drift without SLA risk, information exception	Control Tower	No management escalation unless condition

2. Severity upgrade rules

- Upgrade severity when shipment value, customer criticality, SLA exposure or elapsed duration materially increases.
- Exception type does not permanently determine severity; severity follows actual impact.
- Any security or safety concern overrides normal commercial thresholds.

3. Closure criteria

- Root cause is confirmed or explicitly recorded as unresolved with final disposition.
- Recovery action is complete or no longer required.
- Customer communication obligations are satisfied.
- Financial or claim follow-up is assigned where applicable.
- Incident timeline and final outcome are recorded.

Records and audit trail

All material actions, timestamps, approvals, customer notifications and supporting evidence must be recorded against the shipment or incident reference in the transport management system.

Control note

This internal document does not replace Saudi laws, customs instructions, carrier terms, customer contracts or directions issued by competent authorities.